FREE RESOURCE · PROMPT PACK

The Automated *Podcast* Kit

Every prompt and setup step I used to build Build By AI, a weekly podcast that writes, voices and publishes itself with Claude and ElevenLabs.

Paste the prompts into Claude in order and you get the same pipeline: news in, two-host episode out, live on Spotify and Apple Podcasts every week. No coding needed, and nothing to install on your computer.

WOMEN LEAD AI

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BEFORE YOU START

What you need and *how it connects*

The brain

Claude

Picks the stories, writes and fact checks the script, and builds the whole project for you through claude.ai/code.

The voices

ElevenLabs

Turns every line into audio. Pick two clearly different voices from the Voice Library, one per host.

The schedule

GitHub + Actions

Your podcast lives in a private repository and runs on a free weekly schedule, so your laptop can stay off.

The publisher

Captivate or Buzzsprout

Hosts the MP3s and sends each episode to Spotify and Apple Podcasts for you.

How the pieces fit

- [ ] **Your podcast lives on GitHub.**
  Claude is connected to GitHub, so it writes the code straight into your project.
- [ ] **ElevenLabs is connected to Claude through Settings › Connectors.**
  So Claude can browse the voice library and make test clips with you.
- [ ] **Your private keys live in GitHub secrets.**
  A locked box that only your podcast can open when it runs each week. Never paste keys into a chat.

SETUP CHECKLIST

Set it up *once*

- [ ] **Create a private GitHub repository**
  Free account, New repository, set it to Private, call it something like my-podcast.

- [ ] **Connect GitHub to Claude**
  Go to claude.ai/code, connect GitHub and give Claude access to that repository.

- [ ] **Connect ElevenLabs**
  Claude, Settings, Connectors, ElevenLabs, Connect, then approve it in ElevenLabs.

- [ ] **Create your show on Captivate (or Buzzsprout)**
  Connect it to Spotify and Apple Podcasts once by hand.

- [ ] **Add these GitHub secrets**
  Repository Settings, Secrets and variables, Actions, New repository secret:

```
ANTHROPIC_API_KEY            console.anthropic.com, API keys (add a little credit)
ELEVENLABS_API_KEY           ElevenLabs profile, API keys
ELEVENLABS_VOICE_ID_HOST_A   voice ID of host one
ELEVENLABS_VOICE_ID_HOST_B   voice ID of host two
CAPTIVATE_USER_ID            Captivate account settings
CAPTIVATE_API_KEY            Captivate account settings
CAPTIVATE_SHOW_ID            Captivate account settings
```

LESSON FROM MY DAY TWO

Make sure there is no space or empty line after a key when you paste it. An invisible new line at the end of my keys broke my uploads.

SAY TO CLAUDE · CHOOSE YOUR HOSTS

"Using ElevenLabs, show me 6 voices that would suit a conversational tech podcast, three that sound like a calm, clear host and three that sound more energetic. Make one short test clip of each saying 'Welcome back to the show, there's a lot to get through this week' so I can listen, then give me the voice IDs of the two I pick."

PROMPTS 0 TO 2

Plan first, then *build in stages*

Gather news feeds	**Pick** Claude Haiku	**Write** Claude Sonnet	**Fact check** Claude
Voice ElevenLabs	**Mix** -16 LUFS	**Publish** Captivate	**Promote** website

PROMPT 0 · THE PLAN

"I want to build a fully automated weekly AI news podcast in Python in this repository. Every Wednesday it should read AI news from RSS feeds, use the Claude API to pick the 8 most important stories and write a 30 minute conversation between two hosts, fact check the script, turn it into audio with the ElevenLabs API using a different voice for each host, mix it into one MP3 with an intro and outro jingle, upload it to Captivate and email me when it's live. It will run on GitHub Actions, and the keys are already saved as GitHub secrets called ANTHROPIC_API_KEY, ELEVENLABS_API_KEY, ELEVENLABS_VOICE_ID_HOST_A, ELEVENLABS_VOICE_ID_HOST_B, CAPTIVATE_USER_ID, CAPTIVATE_API_KEY and CAPTIVATE_SHOW_ID. Build it as separate stages and make every stage save its result, so if something fails halfway it can carry on from where it stopped. Show me the plan first and don't write any code until I say yes."

PROMPT 1 · GATHER THE NEWS

"Build stage one. Put the news feeds in a config file called rss_feeds.yaml so I can change them without touching the code, and give each source a weight. Start with The Verge, TechCrunch's AI section, Ars Technica, MIT Technology Review, Wired's AI feed, and the OpenAI, Anthropic, Google AI and Meta AI blogs, with the company blogs weighted slightly higher. Only keep articles from the last 7 days and remove duplicates."

Different topic? Property, skincare, your industry: this feed list is the only thing you change.

PROMPT 2 · PICK THE STORIES

"Build stage two. To keep the cost low, send only the headlines and source names, up to 80 of them, to Claude Haiku and ask it to pick the 8 most important stories for a general audience that's curious about AI. Prioritise product launches, funding, policy changes and research breakthroughs, and skip stock market analysis, opinion pieces and very niche papers. Then summarise only those 8, and label each one 'verified' if more than one source reported it or 'single source' if only one did."

PROMPTS 3 AND 4

Two hosts who *sound real*

PROMPT 3 · WRITE THE SCRIPT

"Build stage three using Claude Sonnet. Create a host_profiles.yaml with two hosts. Alex Shannon is the driver: sets up each story, gives the facts and asks 'so what does this mean?', grounded and clear, like Paul Roetzer. Sam Hinton is the analyst: more opinionated and energetic, connects stories to bigger trends and sometimes pushes back, like Mike Kaput. Write the episode with every line labelled with who says it. It must be 4,500 to 5,500 words, and if it comes back shorter, send it back to Claude and ask for more depth, not padding. For single source stories, the hosts must use careful language like 'early reports suggest'."

PROMPT 3B · COLD OPENS AND MEMORY

"Give the script seven different cold open styles and rotate them automatically by date: starting mid argument, a hypothetical question, a personal reaction, the stakes, a hot take the other host has thirty seconds to justify, something absurd in the news, and a near future scenario. The first line must never start with 'So', 'OK' or 'Well'. Before writing, read the last 5 episodes so the hosts can naturally refer back to stories they've covered before."

PROMPT 4 · FACT CHECK

"Build stage four. Before any audio is made, send the script and the story summaries to Claude Sonnet and check every claim against the summaries: made up facts, numbers or dates, things attributed to the wrong company, exaggerations, and single source stories that aren't hedged. Also check both hosts speak roughly equally, within a 60/40 split. Fix any problems and save a readable copy of the final script."

PROMPTS 5 TO 8

Voices, mix, *publish*

PROMPT 5 · VOICES

"Build stage five. Use the ElevenLabs API with the ELEVENLABS_API_KEY secret and the two voice ID secrets. Split the script into individual lines and send each one to ElevenLabs text to speech with the turbo model, host A's voice for Alex and host B's voice for Sam, with stability 0.55 and similarity boost 0.75. Save each line as its own MP3. Retry a line if it fails, and if too many lines fail, stop with a clear error showing what ElevenLabs said. Never carry on with missing audio."

PROMPT 6 · MIX

"Build stage six. Stitch the line MP3s together in order with a 300 millisecond pause when the same host keeps talking, 500 milliseconds when the other host comes in, and 1.2 seconds between stories. Play intro.mp3 after the cold open and outro.mp3 at the end, and level the volume to minus 16 LUFS, the standard podcast loudness."

PROMPT 7 · PUBLISH

"Build stage seven. Upload the finished MP3 to Captivate using the CAPTIVATE_USER_ID, CAPTIVATE_API_KEY and CAPTIVATE_SHOW_ID secrets, publish it straight away, and use the title and description from the script with the date at the end. Before uploading, check this episode wasn't already uploaded, so a retry never creates a duplicate. Then email me that the episode is live with the title and link, and email me which stage failed if anything goes wrong. Tell me if you need any extra secrets for the email."

PROMPT 8 · PROMOTE

"Build stage eight. After publishing, create a page for the episode on my website with the title, the stories covered, the Spotify and Apple Podcasts links and the full transcript, and commit it to this repository so the site updates automatically."

AUTOPILOT AND FIXES

Put it on *autopilot*

PROMPT 9 · THE WEEKLY SCHEDULE

"Write a GitHub Actions workflow that runs every Wednesday at 4:30am UTC, installs everything it needs, uses the GitHub secrets, and runs the whole pipeline. If it fails, retry once and continue from the last saved stage. Also let me start it manually with a button."

Then open the Actions tab, choose your workflow and press **Run workflow** to watch your first episode being made. Listen to the whole thing before you tell anyone about it.

PROMPT 10 · WHEN A RUN FAILS

"Check the latest GitHub Actions run and tell me why it failed, then fix it."

PROMPT 11 · BRAND NAMES SAID WRONG

"Some brand names are mispronounced in the audio. Create a pronunciations.yaml file where I can list each name with a phonetic spelling, and swap those names only in the text sent to ElevenLabs, not in the script, transcript or website. Match whole words only, and start with Nvidia as 'En-vidia' and Qwen as 'Chwen'."

What broke for me, so it doesn't for you

- [ ] **Silent episodes with a green tick.**
  ElevenLabs returned no audio, my code carried on and published just the jingles, twice. Hence "never carry on with missing audio".
- [ ] **Retired models.**
  Anthropic retired the model my script used and runs failed until I switched. Check your podcast every so often.
- [ ] **Invisible new lines in keys.**
  Paste secrets with nothing after them.